

50.2 USING STATE VERBS IN CONTINUOUS FORMS

Some verbs can be both action and state verbs. When these verbs are describing an action, they can be used in continuous forms.

ACTION



I **am thinking** about taking up fencing.

[Right now, I'm considering taking up fencing.]



The chef **was tasting** his soup.

[The chef is testing the soup's flavor.]



I'm **seeing** some friends for lunch tomorrow.

[I'm meeting some friends tomorrow.]

STATE



I **think** fencing is a great sport.

[In my opinion, fencing is a great sport.]



This soup **tasted** disgusting!

[The soup has a disgusting flavor.]



I **saw** some birds at the park yesterday.

[There were some birds at the park.]

A few state verbs can be used in continuous forms, keeping their stative meaning.

The use of a continuous form emphasizes a change, development, or temporary situation.

CONTINUOUS FORM



Are you **feeling** better today?
You **seemed** sick yesterday.



We're **sounding** much better than usual!



My leg **is** really **hurting** this morning.

SIMPLE FORM



How do you **feel** about modern art?



I wish they'd stop. they **sound** terrible!



My leg **hurts**. Maybe I should go to the doctor.